MAT215: Complex Variables and Laplace Transformations

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Lecture 06

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2. The Complex Exponential
   - Complex Powers
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Intuition

If you want to study a space, it is often helpful to study how functions behave on that space.
When we view $\mathbb{C}$ as $\mathbb{R}^2$ with extra structure, a complex-valued function

$$f : \mathbb{C} \to \mathbb{C}, \qquad z \mapsto w = f(z)$$

has both input and output in two real dimensions.
So the pair $(z, f(z))$ really lives in 4 real dimensions:

$$(z, f(z)) = (x, y, u, v).$$

That is why visualizing complex functions needs some clever tricks.

Ways to Visualize Complex Functions

There are several common ways to visualize complex functions:

- Domain coloring
- $3D$ plots
- Vector fields
- z-w planes
- Riemann sphere

In domain coloring, the output $f(z)$ is represented by color:

$$\text{Hue} \leftrightarrow \text{Argument}, \qquad \text{Lightness} \leftrightarrow \text{Modulus}.$$

$3D$ Plots

In a $3D$ plot, we sacrifice one real variable from

$$(z, f(z)) = (x, y, u, v)$$

and represent the missing variable by color.
For example:

$$\text{missing } v \leftrightarrow \text{color}.$$

For more details: `https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NtoIXhUgqSk`.

Multi-Valued Functions and Branches

Definition

A multi-valued function f on $E \subset \mathbb{C}$ assigns a set of complex values to each $z \in E$. In other words, $f(z)$ is a set of complex numbers.

Definition

A branch of a multi-valued function f on $E \subset \mathbb{C}$ is a single-valued function obtained by choosing one value from $f(z)$ for each $z \in E$.

A Complex Function as Two Real Functions

For a function

$$f : D \subseteq \mathbb{C} \to \mathbb{C},$$

write

$$z = x + iy, \qquad w = f(z) = u + iv.$$

Then

$$w = f(x + iy) = u(x, y) + iv(x, y).$$

So instead of studying one complex function, we can study two real-valued functions:

$$u(x, y) \quad \text{and} \quad v(x, y).$$

Polar Point of View

If

$$z = re^{i\theta},$$

then the output can also be written as

$$w = f(z) = f(re^{i\theta}) = u(r,\theta) + iv(r,\theta).$$

Sometimes rectangular coordinates are more convenient, and sometimes polar coordinates are better.
This depends on the function we are studying.

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Complex Exponential

The exponential function is

$$\exp : \mathbb{C} \to \mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\},$$

defined by

$$\exp(z) = \exp(x + iy) = e^x e^{iy}.$$

Using Euler's formula,

$$e^{iy} = \cos y + i \sin y,$$

we get

$$\exp(x + iy) = e^x(\cos y + i \sin y).$$

Modulus and Argument of e^z

From

$$\exp(x+iy) = e^x e^{iy},$$

we immediately obtain:

$$|\exp(x+iy)| = e^x, \qquad \arg(\exp(x+iy)) = y + 2\pi\mathbb{Z}.$$

So:

- the real part x controls the modulus,
- the imaginary part y controls the argument.

Why Is the Exponential Map a Homomorphism?

For $z_1, z_2 \in \mathbb{C}$,

$$e^{z_1+z_2} = e^{z_1} e^{z_2}.$$

So the exponential map is a homomorphism from the additive group $(\mathbb{C}, +)$ to the multiplicative group $(\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}, \cdot)$.
Its kernel is

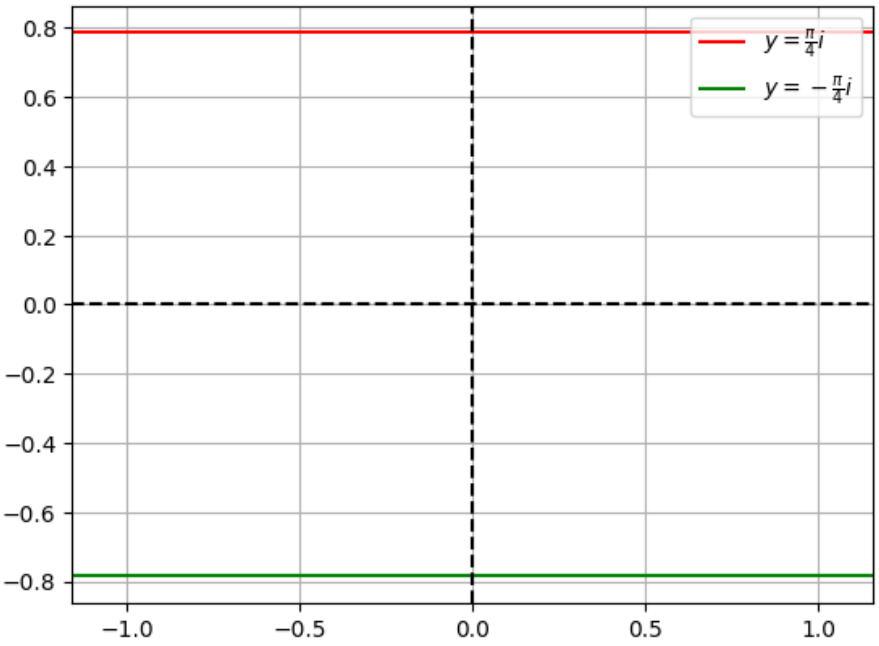
$$\ker(\exp) = 2\pi i\,\mathbb{Z}.$$

Hence it induces

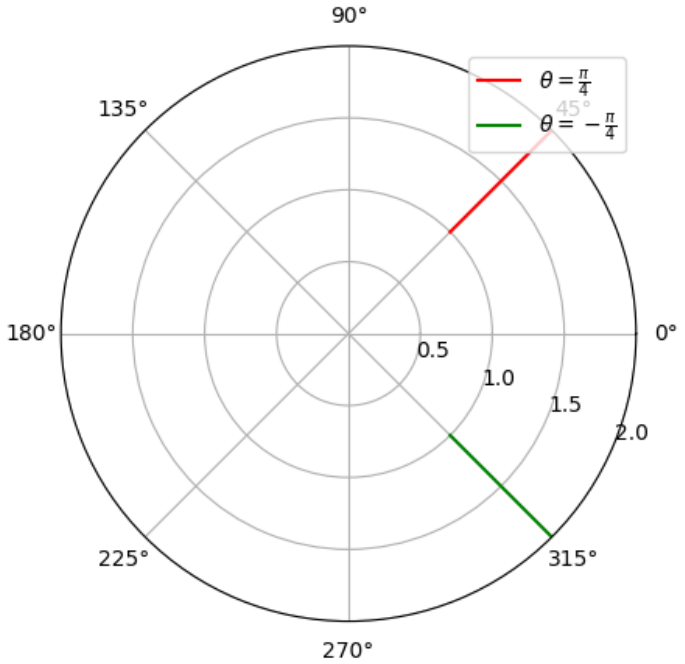
$$\exp : \big(\mathbb{C}/(2\pi i\,\mathbb{Z}), +\big) \to (\mathbb{C} \setminus \{0\}, \cdot).$$

The period is in the imaginary direction, so the quotient must be by $2\pi i\,\mathbb{Z}$, not by $2\pi\mathbb{Z}$.

Horizontal Lines Under $w = e^z$



Input: $z = x \pm \frac{\pi}{4}i$



Output: $r = e^x,\ \theta = \pm\frac{\pi}{4}$

Horizontal Lines Become Rays

For the line

$$z = x + \frac{\pi}{4}i,$$

we get

$$\exp(z) = \exp\left(x + \frac{\pi}{4}i\right) = e^x e^{i\pi/4}.$$

Comparing with polar form:

$$r = e^x, \qquad \theta = \frac{\pi}{4}.$$

So the image is a ray making angle $\frac{\pi}{4}$ with the positive real axis.
Similarly,

$$z = x - \frac{\pi}{4}i \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \exp(z) = e^x e^{-i\pi/4},$$

which is the ray at angle $-\frac{\pi}{4}$.

Why Does the Ray Not Include the Origin?

For

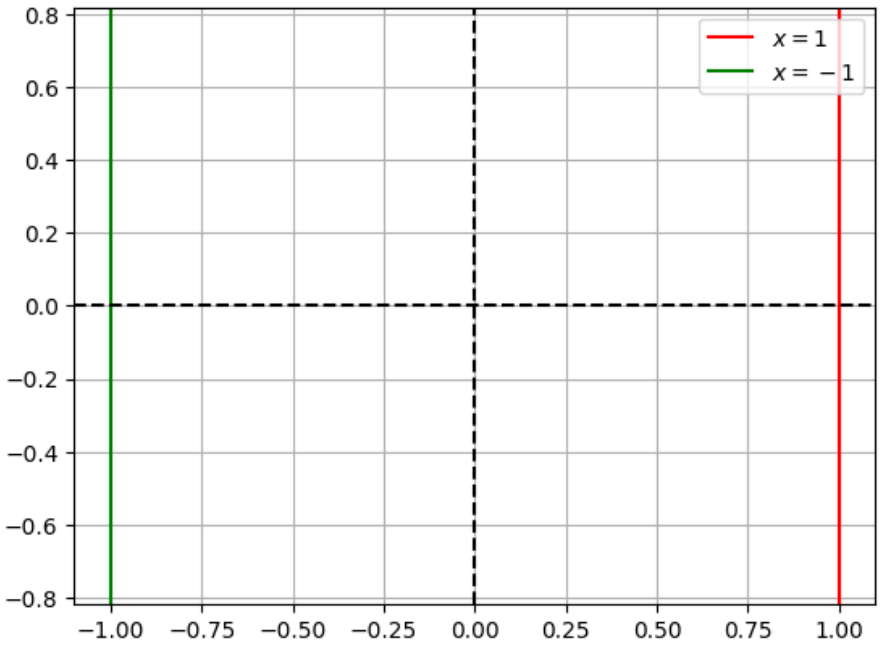
$$\exp(z) = e^x e^{i\theta},$$

the modulus is

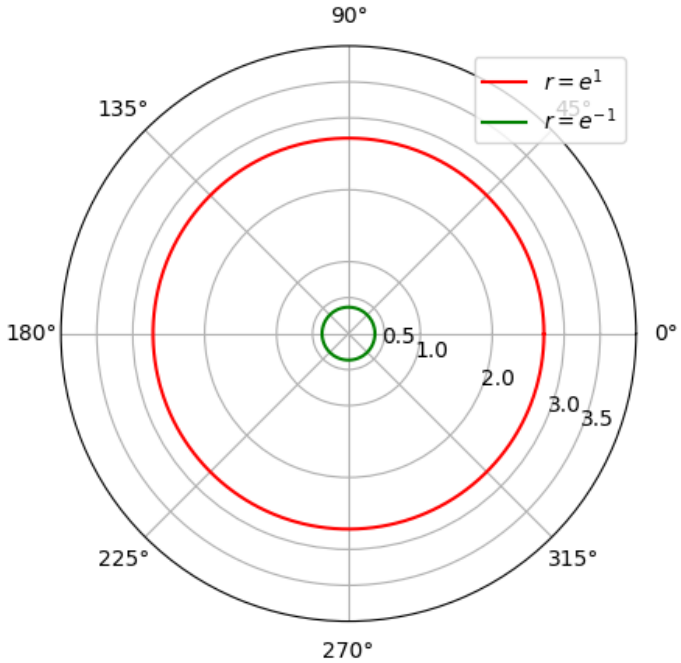
$$r = e^x.$$

But $e^x > 0$ for every real x, so the modulus can get arbitrarily small, but it can never be 0.
That is why the image ray approaches the origin but never actually reaches it.

Vertical Lines Under $w = e^z$



Input: $z = \pm 1 + iy$



Output: $r = e^{\pm 1}$

Vertical Lines Become Circles

Take

$$z = 1 + iy.$$

Then

$$\exp(z) = \exp(1 + iy) = e^1 e^{iy}.$$

So

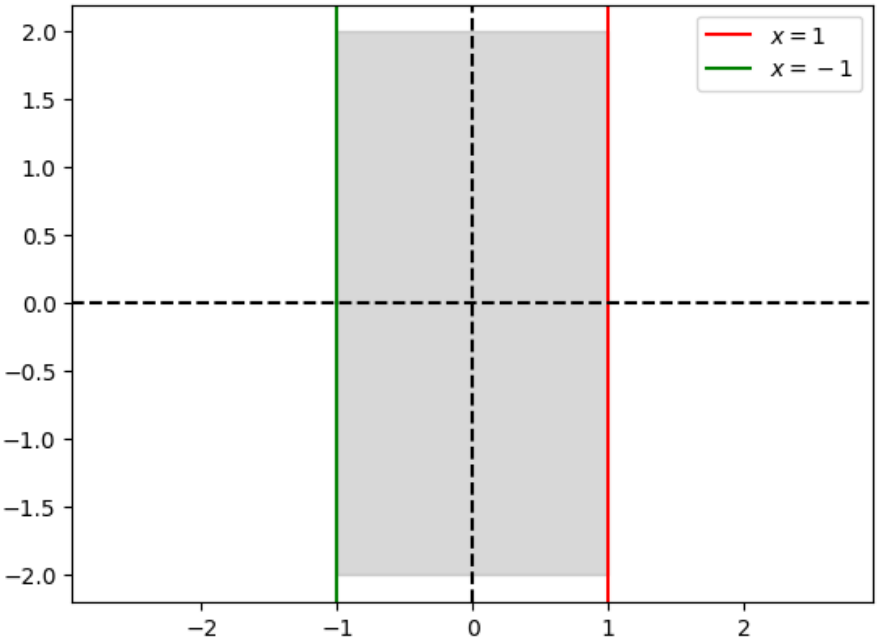
$$r = e, \qquad \theta = y.$$

Since y varies, the angle varies while the radius stays fixed. Therefore the image is the circle of radius e.
Likewise,

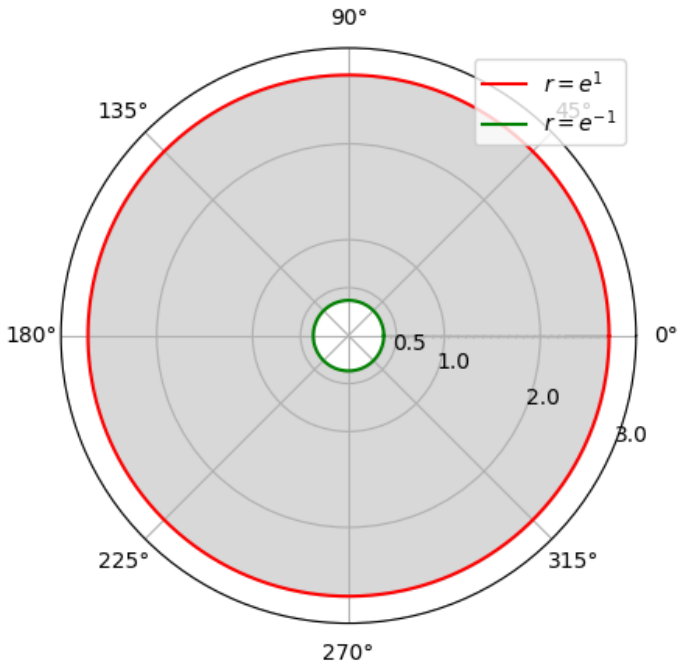
$$z = -1 + iy$$

maps to the circle of radius e^{-1}.

A Vertical Strip Under $w = e^z$



Input strip: $-1 \leq \Re(z) \leq 1$



Output annulus: $e^{-1} \leq |w| \leq e$

Vertical Strip Becomes an Annulus

Let

$$z = x + iy, \qquad -1 \le x \le 1.$$

Under $w = e^z$,

$$|w| = e^x.$$

So:

$$x = 1 \Longrightarrow |w| = e, \qquad x = -1 \Longrightarrow |w| = e^{-1}.$$

Hence

$$e^{-1} \le |w| \le e.$$

Since y is free, the argument runs through all angles, so the strip maps onto the annulus bounded by

$$|w| = e^{-1} \quad \text{and} \quad |w| = e.$$

Exercise

Exercise

Find the image of the horizontal strip in the z-plane lying between

$$z = x + \frac{\pi}{4}i \qquad \text{and} \qquad z = x - \frac{\pi}{4}i$$

under the map $w = e^z$.

Complex Powers

With the logarithm, we can define complex powers.
Let $\alpha \in \mathbb{C}$. For $z \neq 0$, define

$$z^{\alpha} \equiv e^{\alpha \log z}.$$

Using $\log z = \log |z| + i \arg(z)$, this becomes

$$z^{\alpha} = e^{\alpha \log |z| + i\alpha \arg(z)}.$$

Because $\arg(z)$ is multi-valued, z^{α} is generally multi-valued as well.

Why Complex Powers Are Multi-Valued

Write

$$\arg(z) = \operatorname{Arg}(z) + 2\pi k, \qquad k \in \mathbb{Z}.$$

Then

$$z^{\alpha} = e^{\alpha \log|z| + i\alpha(\operatorname{Arg}(z)+2\pi k)} = e^{\alpha \log|z| + i\alpha \operatorname{Arg}(z)}\, e^{i2\pi\alpha k}.$$

So different integers k may produce different values.
Depending on α, the function may have:

- one value,
- finitely many values,
- infinitely many values.

Exercise

Exercise

Find all possible values of i^i and 1^i.

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Hyperbolic Functions First

Recall:

$$\sinh x = \frac{e^x - e^{-x}}{2}, \qquad \cosh x = \frac{e^x + e^{-x}}{2}, \qquad \tanh x = \frac{e^x - e^{-x}}{e^x + e^{-x}}.$$

Now plug in purely imaginary numbers into the trigonometric formulas.

Trigonometric–Hyperbolic Identities

We compute:

$$\cos(ix) = \frac{e^{i(ix)} + e^{-i(ix)}}{2} = \frac{e^{-x} + e^{x}}{2} = \cosh x.$$

Similarly,

$$\sin(ix) = i \sinh x, \qquad \tan(ix) = i \tanh x.$$

Formula for $\sin(x + iy)$

Using angle addition,

$$\sin(x + iy) = \sin x \cos(iy) + \cos x \sin(iy).$$

Now use

$$\cos(iy) = \cosh y, \qquad \sin(iy) = i \sinh y.$$

Therefore,

$$\sin(x + iy) = \sin x \cosh y + i \cos x \sinh y.$$

Formula for $\cos(x + iy)$

Similarly,

$$\cos(x + iy) = \cos x \cos(iy) - \sin x \sin(iy).$$

Hence,

$$\cos(x + iy) = \cos x \cosh y - i \sin x \sinh y.$$